

Capture these five numbers **before** your AI pilot starts.

Otherwise you cannot prove it worked, even when it did.



Samy Yusif

AI Products Section Head

Scope it to one task, not one department.

A department carries too many variables to attribute anything to. One repeatable task with a clear input and output is the only thing you can measure honestly.



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AI Products Section Head

Time twenty real cases before anyone touches the tool.

`baseline = median minutes, n=20`

Use the median, not the average, so one nightmare case does not define your baseline. Record who did them and under what conditions.



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AI Products Section Head

Count rework on those exact same twenty cases.

```
rework rate = reworked / 20
```

Speed without a quality baseline is how pilots fake success. If output is faster but rework doubles, you made things worse and the clock will never show it.



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AI Products Section Head

Price a case fully loaded, not by salary alone.

```
cost = (rate x hours) + tooling + review
```

Include the reviewer. Most AI pilots move work from the doer to the checker, and any cost model that ignores the checker will always look like a win.



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AI Products Section Head

Write the success threshold down before you start.

Decide the exact number that means continue and the one that means stop. A threshold chosen after the results is not a threshold, it is a justification.



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Adoption metrics are the most comfortable way to lie.

Seats used, prompts sent and logins are activity, not value. Report them and you will pass the steering meeting and still not know whether the thing worked.



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67%

of bought AI tools delivered value, against roughly 22% of internal builds, across the 300 projects MIT analysed.



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You cannot recover a baseline you never took.

But you can still take one this week, on the next task in the queue, before the tool ever touches it. Ten cases beats zero.



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